

Evanns Morales-Cuadrado

U.S. Citizen

Robotics PhD Candidate Georgia Institute of Technology

CONTACT

Email: evannsmc@gmail.com

Github: <https://github.com/evannsmc>

Research Website: <https://www.evannsmc.com/>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/evanns-morales/>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, C/C++, C#/.NET, Matlab/Simulink
- **Robotics & Control Frameworks:** ROS 2, NATS, PX4, ArduPilot, acados, CasADi
- **Machine Learning & Simulation:** JAX, PyTorch, MuJoCo, Reinforcement Learning
- **Development & DevOps Tools:** Docker, Continuous Integration, Git/GitHub
- **Hardware & Experimentation:** UAV assembly, repair, and deployment
- **Motion-Capture:** OptiTrack and Vicon
- **Languages:** Spanish (Native), English (Native)

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology | 2022-2027

Ph.D. in Robotics

Doctoral Minor in Optimization Methods

- GPA: 4.0/4.0
- Advisor: Dr. Samuel Coogan
- Thesis Proposal Approved (ABD)
- Goizueta Fellow

University of Texas at Arlington | 2018-2022

Honors Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering

Minor in Mathematics

Minor in Physics

Certificate in Unmanned Vehicle Systems

- GPA: 3.9/4.0 Summa Cum laude
- Full National Merit Scholarship Awarded
- Electrical Engineering Honors Scholar

WORK EXPERIENCE

Year-Round Graduate Research Intern | AI for Autonomy

May 2026 - Present

Sandia National Laboratories

Albuquerque, NM

- Conducted applied research using reinforcement learning for autonomous systems
- Created novel robotics and automation infrastructure to advance national interests
- Developed C#/.NET networking frameworks and execution scripts for coordinating communication and task execution across multi-robot systems

Graduate Research Assistant | FACTS Lab

August 2022 - Present

Georgia Institute of Technology

Atlanta, GA

- Advised by Dr. Samuel Coogan
- Implemented novel aggressive tracking control methods on quadrotor hardware
- Developed novel nonlinear control methods for safe autonomy
- Published novel research at top conferences and journals in the fields of robotics and control theory

Research Assistant | Autonomous Systems Lab

November 2021 - May 2022

University of Texas at Arlington

Arlington, TX

- Advised by Dr. Frank Lewis
- Received personal mentorship from a leading researcher in the field of controls and reinforcement learning (ranked 12th in the USA and 23rd in the world during my time in his lab)
- Aided graduate students on reinforcement learning research applied to quadrotor control

Research Assistant | Dynamical Networks and Control Lab
University of Texas at Arlington

October 2019 - May 2022
Arlington, TX

- Advised by Dr. Yan Wan
- Gained experience with Robot Operating System (ROS), OpenCV, and path planning
- Original research in learning-based minimum time and energy path-planning for multi-vehicle systems

**SELECTED
PUBLICATIONS**

E. Morales-Cuadrado, L. Chung, S. Kousik and S. Coogan, “RTD-RAX: Fast, Safe Trajectory Planning for Systems under Unknown Disturbances.” Joint Submission to 2026 MECC-ALDSC. (*accepted preprint available*).

L. Baird, **E. Morales-Cuadrado**, and S. Coogan, “Runtime Assurance for Uncertain Systems from Interval Signal Temporal Logic.” Submitted to IFAC Nonlinear Analysis: Hybrid Systems (NAHS), 2025. (*under revision*) *preprint available*.

E. Morales-Cuadrado, L. Baird, Y. Wardi and S. Coogan, “Lightweight Tracking Control for Computationally Constrained Aerial Systems with the Newton-Raphson Method.” *IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology*, 2026. (*early access; to appear*) *preprint available*.

**OPEN-SOURCE
CONTRIBUTIONS**

- **PX4 Autopilot**: Contributed documentation improvements to the official PX4 Autopilot manual.
- **Vicon4PX4**: Developed and open-sourced a ROS 2 C++ Vicon–PX4 interface enabling external vision fusion for indoor quadrotor flight experiments; adopted and showcased by Georgia Tech’s Indoor Flight Lab as part of its official codebase. Also created a parallel package for OptiTrack systems.

**SERVICE &
LEADERSHIP**

Co-Founder and President of Puerto Rican Student Association
Georgia Institute of Technology

August 2024 - Present
Atlanta, GA

- Addressed the need for an organization to help Puerto Rican students feel at home and stay connected to our culture
- Formed a three-member co-founder board and identified a faculty advisor
- Raised funds for the organization and recruited members from campus
- Hosted professional, social, and cultural events to meet the needs of the growing Puerto Rican student population at Georgia Tech

**HONORS AND
AWARDS**

Top-3 Finalist at a Deep Learning Research Symposium

November 2023

Professor-sponsored award for novel research in deep learning and robotics

Goizueta Fellowship at Georgia Tech

August 2022

Highly selective fellowship for graduate students of Latin-American descent

Summa Cum Laude Honors at University of Texas at Arlington

May 2022

Exceptional academic distinction in top GPA tier for graduation honors

Electrical Engineering Honors Scholar at University of Texas at Arlington

December 2021

Inaugural member of the electrical engineering honors cohort

IEEE-HKN International Electrical Engineering Honor Society Membership

August 2021

Selective undergraduate society recognizing outstanding academic achievement and community service

Chance Vought Engineering and Science Endowment Scholarship

August 2020

Highly selective award given annually to three recipients across the entire College of Engineering

National Hispanic Scholar

March 2018

Recognition of top national performers of Latin descent on the SAT

National Merit Scholar

March 2018

Recognition of top national performers on the SAT